

Khwela Womxn

<https://khwela.org.za/>

Disclaimer: Some of Khwela Womxn's history has been omitted to allow for a focused narrative in the case study below.

Background - Setting the Context

Unemployment in South Africa has always been a problem that the post-apartheid government has been battling to solve through various means - like education, social grants etc. Since COVID-19 and the implementation of various lockdown regulations, 1/12 individuals have lost their jobs. It has also left us with a youth unemployment rate of over 55.5% since 2020 due to the fact that students leaving university or school are unable to find jobs in an already under-stimulated economy.

Originally, a non-profit organisation which empowered more womxn to get into the Tourism sector, Khwela Youth, had to change strategy given the constraints of the pandemic. So the team pivoted to become Khwela Womxn, with the goal of:

Equipping womxn with opportunities for experiential learning and increased access to safe peer-mentorship spaces, so that they can transform their mindsets and uplift themselves personally and professionally.

The idea is to create safe spaces, known as Sister'hood' circles, for womxn to be vulnerable about the growth and life struggles that they are going through, so that they can share their experiences and knowledge with others who can do the same. By identifying areas where womxn between the ages of 18 and 25 are struggling most, the Khwela Womxn team is then able to reach out to expert mentors in their network to mentor and create training or WhatsApp bot content which can be shared with the community.

Benefits

Becoming a member of the Khwela Womxn community is beneficial to womxn because:

1. They are encouraged to adopt a growth mindset and take ownership for improving their own personal and professional lives,
2. The credible education that they need to uplift themselves is provided in an accessible, easy-to-use format (like Alora, their WhatsApp bot) or directly in circles,
3. They gain access to a support structure of peers and mentors, and
4. There are opportunities to learn practical skills for professional growth, as well as personal growth and development.

Why Sister‘hood’ Circles?

The Khwela Womxn team believes that self-empowered womxn can be a change agent for their communities. Therefore, it has decided to focus its efforts on educating young womxn who constantly choose to grow and invest in themselves, so that they may socially uplift themselves, and in turn the communities around them. Bringing womxn together, in the form of facilitated Sister‘hood’ Circles, is a catalyst for this change and upliftment.

The process of setting up these circles includes:

- Training moderators to facilitate circles around SA
- Recruiting and allocating womxn to circles
- Creating credible, learning content that can be shared in circles and on [Alora](#), their WhatsApp bot.

Moderator Training

Once a womxn has attended 3 Sister‘hood’ Circles, and knows their purpose and how they work, then she can sign up to receive training to be a circle moderator. The team will then set out on a Training Roadshow across South Africa to train moderators that can facilitate circles in and around the major cities: Cape Town, Johannesburg, East London and Durban.

This 2-day training is completely free (including accommodation and catering) and attendees only have to organise transport to and from the venue. The focus of the training is to explain the process of how Sister‘hood’ Circles came to be, what their goals are and how to facilitate them in a way that creates safe spaces for womxn going forward.

After the training, these Khwela Womxn are supported by Engagement Coaches to ensure that they have everything that they need in order to set up their own circles and recruit new members.

Sister‘hood’ Circle Allocation

When a womxn wants to join the Khwela Womxn community, they will sign up to be part of a circle. This can currently be done through the [Khwela Womxn website](#), which is linked to the team’s Airtable base back-end.

A team member then has to manually phone and talk to each sign-up to establish their needs and which circles would be the best fit for them. Once the call has happened, they will either be introduced to an existing moderator who will ask their circle’s permission for a new member to join. If there is no circle available that is accessible to the Khwela Womxn sign-up, then they will be added to a waiting list until a circle is available for them to join.

Overall, it is most ideal for womxn to join circles that are easy for them to attend (i.e. in their area) or easy to access online through WhatsApp.

Creating Learning Content for Alora (WhatsApp bot)

At the end of every Sister'hood' circle, the moderator reports back to the Khwela Womxn team on the top themes and topics that were covered during the circle discussion. These themes often highlight areas where womxn are struggling or trying to grow and learn.

With this information, the team is then able to reach out to their network of experts in order to set up a content collaboration. This means collaborators work with the Khwela Womxn team to develop credible, learning content on the topics that the community is eager to gain knowledge on.

The content is currently all stored in the most accessible format for most young, South African Womxn - a WhatsApp bot! Her name is Alora, and she acts as a virtual mentor for womxn who may not otherwise have access to a network who can help them learn what she has on her system.

Some pictures to inspire you:



Circle Setup Procedures

Currently, there is a very manual, resource-intensive process for assigning womxn to circles. As a result, the user journeys are still undefined which has made it difficult to deliver a consistent experience to all womxn who join Khwela Womxn.

These are the steps currently followed to make Sister'hood' Circles happen:

Moderator sign-up and training:

1. Advertise training and its benefits to relevant potential moderators.
2. They sign up through an Airtable form.
3. A team member:
 - a. allocates each sign-up manually to a circle that is in the relevant area, and
 - b. schedules all venues, accommodation and catering (in each city), as well as sets up communication to applicants.
4. At least 2x team members then travel to each city on the Roadshow to train Khwela Womxn Moderators.
5. A team member sends out 'thank you emails' and follows up to get feedback and stumbling blocks from moderators.

Online circle set-up, allocation and facilitation

1. A womxn signs up to be part of a circle in their area when they hear about Khwela on social media, the blog or on Alora. They complete an Airtable form, which pulls into our database.
2. A team member:
 - a. calls them and asks them a few questions to determine what circle to allocate them to (incl. offline/online).
 - b. allocates the now Khwela Womxn, to a circle online.
 - c. ask them which date they'd like to join and allocates the date to their name.
3. A circle moderator:
 - a. adds them to a WhatsApp group.
 - b. make the WhatsApp group video call to host the circle online (1hour).
 - c. confirm manually when they'd like to join the next circle.
 - d. uploads circle selfie (proof of impact) and themes into database.

There is no further tracking on a circle participant's journey, other than attendance records received from moderators (also uploaded manually to Airtable).

In-person circle set-up, allocation and facilitation

1. A womxn signs up to be part of a circle in their area when they hear about Khwela on social media, the blog or on Alora. They complete an Airtable form, which pulls into our database.
2. A team member:
 - a. calls them and asks them a few questions to determine what circle to allocate them to (by geographical location).
 - b. allocates the now Khwela Womxn to a circle near them.
 - c. ask them which date they'd like to join and allocates the date to their name.
3. A circle moderator:
 - a. adds them to a WhatAapp group
 - b. co-ordinates the venue, time of the circle
 - c. hosts the circle for 4 hours
 - d. confirms manually when they'd like to join the next circle.
 - e. uploads circle selfie (proof of impact) and themes into Airtable database.

There is no further tracking on a circle participant's journey, other than attendance records received from moderators (also uploaded manually to Airtable).

Create content to share on Alora

A team member must:

1. manually reach out to moderators or check the database to find out about common circle themes and topics.
2. manually reach out to the team's common network / internal team to create content.
3. edits and uploads to Alora (i.e. WhatsApp Bot).
4. manually asks the team to share content through various distribution channels.

While this is all currently handled by one team member, it would be useful to have a system to automatically capture and track data so that it isn't all so manual. For example, there could be a mentor sign-up for womxn who want to write content, or an automation that facilitates communication between the bot team and the marketing team.

The Tasks

The Khwela Womxn team were informed that second year Information Systems students are doing a Systems Analysis course. They requested that you, as proficient students, use your young and innovative minds to do the analysis and preliminary design to **automate aspects of Moderator Training, Sister'hood' Circle Allocation and related logistics like the further distribution of Circle content via the WhatsApp bot.**

In an ideal world, the Khwela Womxn team would be able to spend more time training womxn, and creating educational content based on experiential learning, and less time doing administrative



tasks. **Having clearly defined user journeys would also help** create experiences that are intentional and safe for the womxn trusting us with their vulnerabilities.

The proposal is to:

- 1) create moderator and circle member user journeys that are automated as far as possible with a unified system, and
- 2) automate logistics relating to all sign-ups, allocations and data collection throughout the Khwela Womxn user journey.